

John Kremers

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Professional Summary

Results-driven production leader with expertise in business management and sales in the precision manufacturing, industrial finishing and powder coating industries. Expertise in scaling businesses, improving efficiency, implementing ERP systems, and driving revenue growth. Skilled in team leadership, process optimization, safety compliance, vendor relations, and project management. Hands-on experience in mechanical troubleshooting, welding, fabricating, forklift operation, and ERP/accounting software (NetSuite, Epicor, Prodsmart, QuickBooks). Extensive experience in estimating, inventory management, purchasing, shipping/receiving, and customer and employee relations.

Core Competencies

Operations & Production Management | Team Leadership & Training | Process Improvement & SOP Implementation | Safety Compliance & Risk Management | ERP Implementation & Inventory Control | Project Management | Purchasing & Vendor Relations | Sales Growth & Customer Relationship Management | Equipment Maintenance & Troubleshooting

Professional Experience

BTD Wood Powder Coating. Brainerd, MN

Powder Coating Production Manager

July 2025 – March 2026

Managed daily powder coating operations and led a team of 10–12 employees across two shifts

Oversaw inventory, purchasing, scheduling and production output

Coordinated packaging and shipping of sensitive materials while maintaining product integrity

Directed preventative maintenance programs ensuring accurate documentation and adherence to SOPs resulting in maximized equipment up-time

Streamlined SOPs to increase efficiency, boost output, and enhance workplace safety

Served on the company safety committee and implemented organization systems to reduce OSHA risk and improve compliance

Improved processes for coating heat-sensitive substrates expanding production capabilities

Vanterra Manufacturing Inc. Paynesville, MN (formerly SafeBasements inc.)

Assistant Plant Manager/Safety Director

August 2023 – June 2025

Managed vendor relations, project management, inventory control, and procurement

Key stakeholder in the implementation of ERP systems (Prodsmart and NetSuite) to improve production planning, inventory accuracy, and financial reporting

Ensured data integrity across plant operations, supporting accounting processes and company growth

Played a key role during company acquisition by private equity, supporting operational transition and scalability

Drove process improvements in scheduling, production planning, safety, supply chain management, and risk reduction

SafeBasements Manufacturing Inc. Paynesville, MN

Dealer Support & Development/Sales

March 2022 – August 2023

Trained for 6 months in the field on foundation repair and waterproofing gaining hands-on experience across installation, sales, and operations

Served as primary liaison for a network of 39 independent installers across the eastern U.S. and Canada

Generated \$3.3M in regional sales through relationship management and strategic support

Advised business owners on operations, lead generation, profitability, and team management to drive growth

Trained installers, sales teams, and warehouse managers on best practices, improving performance and operational consistency of independent SafeBasements dealers

Supported dealer success through coaching on sales strategy, crew management, and inventory control

CC Powder Coating LLP, Granite Falls, MN

General Manager

April 2019 - March 2022

Founded and managed a large capacity powder coating business generating \$390K in revenue

Led and completed full facility setup in less than 2 months including sourcing, transporting, and installing major industrial equipment

Managed all day-to-day operations including staffing, logistics, vendor relations, inventory, estimating, sales and customer satisfaction

Created well-organized production workflows to maximize efficiency

Granite Falls Coating Inc, Granite Falls, MN

General Manager

January 2015 - March 2022

Promoted from laborer/painter to General Manager within 2 years

Drove 40% revenue growth (2017–2019) through improved operations and customer expansion

Led and developed a team of 5–8 employees, managing scheduling, production, and performance

Oversaw estimating, quoting, and budgeting to maintain profitability

Managed shipping, receiving, and logistics, including interstate deliveries

Developed preventative maintenance schedules for equipment to minimize downtime

Operated commercial vehicles up to 26,000 lbs and forklifts up to 7,000lbs

Spearheaded expansion by initiating a partnership that led to the launch of a second powder coating operation

Education

St. Cloud Technical and Community College, St. Cloud, MN

Auto Body Collision Repair

- General education in Business Management
- 1 year of Electrical Construction Courses

Completed coursework in General Business Management, then specialized in collision repair